Corpus: the Mesopotamian Creation Stories → Hebrew

Read `../translation-guidelines.md` first, then this file, then the shared `renderings.md`, then the project's own `project.md`.

Goal (the user's plan, 2026-10-16)

Translate the Mesopotamian creation texts that matter most for **Genesis 1–3**, the block the commentary is working on now (Gen 1, the fifth day: the *tanninim*).
The corpus is the counterpart of the flood corpus (`../סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/`), and it inherits that corpus's conventions and shared renderings.
It comes from items 1–2 of `../curated-translation-candidates.md` and the relevance survey (`../curation-surveys/relevance-survey--2026-10-16.md`, §A 1–7).

The user's standing decisions (from the flood corpus) apply here too:

- partial niqqud (guidelines §6.2): names at first occurrence and ambiguous words;
- deities are never assimilated to biblical names; biblical place names are used for places the Bible names (Babylon = `בָּבֶל`).

The texts and how they relate

#	Project folder	Text	Language, date	Relation to Genesis
1	`1-אנומה-אליש/`	**Enūma eliš**, Tablets I–VII (1,098 lines), the Babylonian Epic of Creation	Akkadian, SB; composed probably under Nebuchadnezzar I (late 12th cent. BCE); mss 9th–2nd cent. BCE	The main external control for Gen 1:1–2:3: Tiāmat / תְּהוֹם, the mingled waters, the sky made from half of Tiāmat, the eleven monsters ↔ the *tanninim*, the stars and the calendar ↔ the luminaries, man made from a god's blood ↔ Gen 1:26–28, the gods' rest ↔ 2:1–3, naming as rule, Babylon's bricks ↔ Gen 11, Marduk's bow ↔ Gen 9:13.
2	`2-טקסטי-בריאה-ועדן/`	**Creation and Eden companions**: Adapa (eBL `L/1/7`, MB + SB); Enki and Ninmaḫ (ETCSL 1.1.2); the Song of the Hoe (ETCSL 5.5.4); Enki and Ninḫursaĝ (ETCSL 1.1.1); the bilingual "Creation of the World by Marduk" (CT 13 35–38; King 1902, check eBL/CDLI); KAR 4 (the creation of man from the Lamga gods' blood; check SEAL); the cosmogonic prologue of Grain and Sheep (ETCSL 5.3.2)	Sumerian, Akkadian, bilingual; OB–NB	Gen 2–3: man from clay / from the ground (2:7, 3:19), the "not yet" chain (2:4b–5), the work of the garden (2:15), the bread and water of life refused (3:22), Dilmun ↔ Eden, the forbidden plants and the curse, Nin-ti and the rib (debated), primeval humans without bread or clothing (Gen 2–4). About 1,000 lines in all.

#	Project folder	Text	Language, date	Relation to Genesis
3	`3-הציפור-והדג/`	**The Debate between Bird and Fish** (ETCSL 5.3.5; 189 lines)	Sumerian, OB copies (c. 1800 BCE) of an Ur III composition (Šulgi)	**Gen 1:20–23, the fifth day**: Enki settles fish and birds together in the marsh and "fills" the reeds with them (1:20, 22); the bird "flying in heaven, walking on earth" (1:20); a Sumerian characterization of the two creatures; the verdict for the bird by its voice. Added 2026-10-19 (round 2, run 1).
4	`4-אנקי-וסדר-העולם/`	**Enki and the World Order** (ETCSL 1.1.3 = ORACC Q000334; 465 lines, ~31% damaged)	Sumerian, OB	The world ordered by allotment: days, months, years (1:14); fish and birds of the marsh (1:20–22); rain (2:5); borders and dwellings for the gods (Deut 32:8); farmer, shepherd, brick, builder, metalworker, drums, weaving as gods' offices (Gen 4:17–22; 11:3–4); Inana without a portion (Deut 10:9). Added 2026-10-19.

Reading order for the commentary: for the fifth day (Gen 1:20–23, the unit now being edited) start with 3 (Bird and Fish) and EWO 250–308 and 89–99; then 1 (Tablets I, IV, V, VI first), then 2 (for Gen 2–3: Adapa, Enki and Ninḫursaĝa, Grain and Sheep, the Founding of Eridu; for Gen 1:26 and man's work: KAR 4, Enki and Ninmaḫ, the Song of the Hoe; for Ex 4:11 and Lev 21: Enki and Ninmaḫ 51–101).

Atra-ḫasīs I (the creation of man from clay and a slain god's flesh and blood) is already translated in the flood corpus (`../סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/1-אתרחסיס/`). Its creation rows are cross-referenced in this corpus's `parallels-index.md`, so that the Gen 1–2 evidence is in one place.

Shared conventions for this corpus

- **`renderings.md` in this folder is shared by all projects of the corpus.** It inherits the flood corpus's shared renderings (`../סיפורי-המבול-המסופוטמיים/renderings.md`) as its default: divine names, formulas and key terms are the same in both corpora, so that a reader can compare, for example, the creation of man in Enūma eliš VI with Atra-ḫasīs I. It adds the creation-specific names and terms.
- **Shared lines get identical Hebrew.** Enūma eliš repeats long passages (Tiāmat's army four times in I–III; Marduk's conditions three times; Anšar's messages). Identical Akkadian gets identical Hebrew, verified by script (guidelines §6.1).
- A project translator does not edit the shared file during drafting; proposals go into the project's `project.md`, and the corpus coordinator merges them.
- **Parallels index:** each project keeps its index (guidelines §7.3). `parallels-index.md` here merges them into one table ordered by Bible verse. This is the main product for the commentary.

Status

#	Project	Status
1	Enūma eliš I–VII	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-16: 1,098 lines (I 162, II 162, III 138, IV 146, V 158, VI 166, VII 166), each tablet with three review passes; repeated lines verified by script (`verify.py`); `translation.rtl.md` generated (`build_translation.py`); print stub `../-1/הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/אנומה-אליש.rtl.md`. Open decisions for the user: `1-אנומה-אליש/project.md`.
2	Creation and Eden companions	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-17: seven texts, 1,076 lines – Adapa (MB 78 + SB 97), Enki and Ninḫursaĝa 305, Enki and Ninmaḫ 142, Song of the Hoe 110, Grain and Sheep 193, Founding of Eridu (BM 93014) 67, KAR 4 84 – drafted text by text by sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified by `verify.py`; `translation.rtl.md` generated (`build_translation.py`); parallels merged into `parallels-index.md`; renderings merged into `renderings.md` §5; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה/המסופוטמיים/2-טקסטי-בריאה-ועדן.rtl.md`. Open decisions: end of `2--טקסטי בריאה-ועדן/project.md`.
3	Bird and Fish	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-19: all 189 lines, one sequential sub-agent, three review passes, verified by `sumerian_tools.py verify 3 --strict`; `translation.rtl.md` generated (`sumerian_tools.py build 3`); 84 parallels rows; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/3-הציפור-והדג.rtl.md`. Open decisions: `3-הציפור-והדג/project.md`.
4	Enki and the World Order	**complete (first draft)**, 2026-10-19: all 465 lines in two files (`annotated-2.rtl.md` 250–472 first, then `annotated-1.rtl.md` 1–249), two sequential sub-agents, three review passes each, verified (`verify 4 --strict`); translation generated (`build 4`); 171 parallels rows; print stub `../הדפסה/סיפורי-הבריאה-המסופוטמיים/4-אנקי-וסדר-העולם.rtl.md`. Open decisions 1–38: `4-אנקי-וסדר-העולם/project.md`.

Corpus-level files

File	What
`renderings.md`	Shared renderings, binding for all projects.
`translator-brief--sumerian.md`	The common brief for Sumerian translators (projects 3–4; reusable).
`sumerian_tools.py`	`verify KEY` / `build KEY` / `grep all '<regex>'` for projects 3–4 (coverage against ETCSL, reserved strings with the Sumerian word that licenses them, name traps, identical lines; the clean translation generated from the annotated `>` lines).
`parallels-index.md`	The projects' parallels indexes merged, ordered by Bible verse, with "Key findings for the commentary" for each project at the top. Regenerate with `python3 אנומה-אליש/build_parallels_index.py -l 1` (reads all four projects).

Notes from the planning of project 2 (done; kept for reference)

- Use the shared renderings: *banû* = בָּנָה, *ṭiṭṭu* = טִיט, *lullû* = קַדְמוֹן, *awīlu* = אָדָם, *dullu* = עָמָל, *šīmtu* = גּוֹרָל, *Apsû* = אַפְּסוּ(הָ), *nabû* (to name) = קָרָא (בְּשֵׁם), Sumerian *edin* = עֲרָבָה (never עֵדֶן).
- Enki = אָנְקִי / Ea = אֵאָה; Ninmaḫ = נִינְמַח; Ninḫursaĝ = נִין־חָרְסַגָּה (flood corpus); Nintu = נִינְתּוּ; Adapa = אֲדָפָה.
- Enūma eliš VI 1–38 (man from Qingu's blood) and the Atra-ḫasīs creation scene are the comparison points for KAR 4 and Enki and Ninmaḫ.